

At the end of a scene, any assets you created which no longer serve a purpose—such as intangible assets based on observations which are no longer relevant or based on positioning on a battlefield your character is no longer on—are discarded. Any assets remaining will stay until the end of the current adventure.



QUALITY

Some assets have a Quality rating if they are of a better Quality than usual. An ordinary example of any particular asset, even a rare one, has a Quality of 0. An ornithopter is no better than a knife as a knife isn't much use if you need to fly, just like an ornithopter is only useful to escape a duel. So, a knife with a Quality rating is better-balanced, more durable, or sharper than an ordinary knife. An ornithopter with Quality is faster, easier to handle, or stronger than a standard ornithopter. The higher the Quality, the more advanced or special the asset is.

QUALITY DESCRIPTION

0	Ordinary, average, or basic in function and effect.
1	Of above-average quality and effectiveness, or unusual in some way.
2	Highly effective or very potent.
3	Extremely well-made or effective.
4	Spectacular or devastating in effect and function.

Quality does not just apply to objects and weapons. Documents with Quality are more complete or damning when used for blackmail or intrigue. Soldiers, servants of criminals in your character's employ may be better trained or better equipped. Favors are more clearly defined and harder to ignore when called upon. Any asset can have Quality, tangible, intangible, or ubiquitous, but where a Quality is not noted it is 0.

An asset's **Quality** determines how effective the asset is when used in a conflict. This takes several forms, and different types of conflict may refer to asset Quality for different purposes. Commonly, if you're using an asset to overcome an extended task, then the asset's Quality

determines how much progress you make towards that task's requirement with each successful skill test.

In any circumstance where you're making a skill test with an asset and the asset's Quality has no other effect within the rules (for that specific test), then the gamemaster may allow you to generate bonus Momentum on a successful test equal to the asset's Quality. This is purely at the gamemaster's discretion and applies only when the gamemaster feels it would make sense.

Quality can be increased as a character advances. The character can improve their equipment and do the same for those that serve them, who may also grow in their skills and training. Physical items might be improved with better technology, sharpened, or even have secret compartments of poison edges added. An asset might even just be swapped out for a newer and more advanced model. Intangible assets can be grown by gains in the character's reputation or further study into their enemies to make one's leverage more powerful. Servants, spies, and soldiers can undergo better training or be given better equipment.

CHARACTER ADVANCEMENT

Your character's assets, or at least the most potent and significant of them, will stay with them and may even grow and develop over time. This represents time and effort invested to refine and improve upon their tools and expand their resources. However, your character can only maintain a finite number of assets in this way, as upkeep and maintenance become an increasingly large drain on time.

Your character may have a total of five permanent assets, though you can increase this number through purchasing certain talents.

At the end of an adventure, after purchasing advancements, you may take any of the following actions to maintain your assets:

- ✧ You may choose to keep any assets you created during the previous adventure, up to your character's maximum limit.
- ✧ If your character is at their maximum number of assets, you may discard any number of them to make room for new assets you have created.
- ✧ You may select one of your assets and increase its Quality by 1 by spending a number of advancement points equal to twice the new Quality of the asset (i.e., if you're increasing an asset from Quality 2 to 3, it costs 3 to 6 advancement points). The asset's name and/or keywords may be updated when you change the Quality, to reflect how the asset has been improved.

ASSETS LISTING



o help you create and understand the array of available assets, we offer the following examples of items and technology to be found throughout the Imperium. We have divided them along the same lines as the types of conflict, to make it easier to see how they might apply. But any asset can be used for any purpose in the right situation. It is up to each player to try and consider how best to use the assets at their command.

- o Personal assets are items that can be carried by individual characters. They apply most often in agent level play. Weapons of this type might be used in a personal duel or a skirmish conflict.
- o Warfare assets are items too large for one person and turn a skirmish into a battlefield. They are usually heavy ordnance, soldiers, or vehicles.
- o Espionage assets are used for assassination, stealth, and information gathering. They come in a variety of forms: some may be personal items, other may be intangible ones, some are agents, spies and even Face Dancers. These assets often suit both agent and architect level play.
- o Intrigue assets are used in social occasions and are often intangible assets. They are based on favor, debts, and reputation, but also include informers and servants.

PERSONAL ASSETS

PERSONAL ASSETS: RANGED WEAPONS

LASGUN

The most commonly used firearm in the Imperium. These continuous wave-laser projectors are fitted into either pistols or rifles, enhancing their range. The beam forms a tight, narrow laser that can be widened, reducing the strength while increasing the area impacted.

Lasguns use an energy cell capable of firing 30 shots before needing to be replaced. The number of shots is based on the narrow beam setting, and wider beams require additional energy. The universe is filled with lasguns, befitting the planet, culture, and group using them, making countless variants available for purchase. They are expensive and sometimes unreliable, and the reaction with shields makes them often undesirable in mass combat, when a stray shot could have catastrophic results.

As an Asset: Lasguns are the conventional method of combat and can be used to destroy obstacles.

Keywords: Laser, Ranged Weapon

MAULA PISTOL

The maula pistol is an assassin's weapon. These pistols have a spring-loaded trigger and can launch poison darts or other projectiles with considerable accuracy up to 40 meters.

They originate from change to beginning of the Faufréluches' period and are closely related to stunners. The needle gun is a variant of the maula pistol.

As an Asset: The silent nature of the maula pistol makes it an excellent choice for assassinations.

Keywords: Concealable, Ranged Weapon, Quiet

PERSONAL ASSETS: MELEE WEAPONS

BLADE

Blades are as ancient as Old Terra and are just as critical for defense now as then. The creation of the personal shield has elevated them into common use. Blades come in a variety of shapes, sizes, and forms. Types of blades include daggers, swords, and rapiers, but many other specialized or culturally specific blades exist.

Since ancient times, numerous new versions of traditional blades have arisen, sometimes crafted from new material, sometimes combined with new technology. Most modern blades are crafted with plasteel or damasteel.

As an Asset: If used correctly, can penetrate a shield, and

thus are a common part of a hand-to-hand combat attack. Some blades are presented as parts of ceremonies, used to signify rank and status. Historically they are known to be given as a diplomatic gift between warring factions.

Keywords: Melee Weapon (different sizes and forms of blade may have additional keywords)

BODKIN

These tiny, well-crafted blades are used for personal defense and are commonly used by assassins. While not useful for cutting, they are exceptional for stabbing attacks. Several noted cutpurses use them as an aid in their crimes.

As an Asset: The bodkin is easily concealed in a wrist sheath and easily disposed of before capture.

Keywords: Concealable, Melee Weapon, Quiet

CRYSKNIFE

This sacred blade of the Fremen is crafted from the tooth of a dead sandworm. An average crysknife possesses a 0.2-meter curved milky-white double blade with a finger-ridged handle. Sometimes the tip of the blade is coated with a deadly, fast-acting poison.

Part of the Fremen tradition surrounding the blade states that one can never be re-sheathed without first drawing blood. Additionally, outsiders are not allowed to view these blades, and if they do, the blade is cleansed through a long ritual or the outsider being put to death.

Crysknives come primarily in two types: unfixed and fixed. Unfixed blades must stay close to a person's electrical field, or they will disintegrate. Fixed blades are treated with a unique process that allows them to be stored.

As an Asset: A crysknife is a status symbol for an outsider among Fremen to show that one is a friend. They are an effective weapon against shielded opponents.

Keywords: Melee Weapon, Sacred

Quality: Even the least crysknives has a Quality 1, and the poison used may increase the Quality further.

KINDJAL

These large curve-bladed knives range from 18–22 cm long. Their use is common among all noble houses who have been taught in their use since the earliest days of the Faufréluches. The ability of these blades to safely bypass shields has increased their popularity to the point that they are commonplace.

As an Asset: The kindjal can cut through personal shields and can be used in artistic displays of sword use. Many noble Houses engrave the hilts with their House emblem.

Keywords: Long Blade, Melee Weapon, Traditional

PULSE-SWORD

The pulse-sword is a melding of two different worlds: the medieval and the technologically advanced. These blades use vibrations to amplify the attacking power of the sword wielder, but as a result are rarely used on Arrakis due to the possibility of attracting sandworms.

As an Asset: The vibration effect of the blade disrupts thinking machine gelcircuitry.

Keywords: Disruptive, Melee Weapon, Vibro-blade

PERSONAL ASSETS:

ARMOR AND DRESS

JUBBA CLOAK

These durable and versatile cloaks are a boon to survivalists. The jubba cloak is a flowing cloak with various styles and functions. The cloaks are easily converted into a hammock or make-shift tent and regulate temperatures by absorbing or radiating heat.

As an Asset: The compact cloak appears like any other cloak and goes unnoticed until used. While mainly a survival tool, the cloaks are sometimes woven with intricate designs and worn as a status symbol.

Keywords: Adaptable, Fashion, Survival

SHIELD

The Holtzman shield is named for the creator of the Holtzman effect, used to create a protective field of energy around a larger area such as a castle, or in some cases a planet. Shields are a common defense for facilities and make the use of lasguns deadly for all sides engaging in the battle, due to the unpredictable interaction of the resultant explosion. A shield can provide protection for more substantial areas, making them much harder to penetrate.

As an Asset: Shields are affordable for those of means, and always a factor when determining strategies against House operatives and soldiers. Their use on Arrakis is limited, as the vibration attracts the worms in a violent rage.

Keywords: Atomic, Impervious, Static Defense

Special: No high-velocity attack can bypass a shield, and it requires colossal amounts of firepower to overwhelm one. Lasguns are as risky to use against emplaced shields as against personal ones. See p.23 for more information about the interaction of lasguns and shields.

SHIELD, PERSONAL

The Holtzman shield was named for the creator of the Holtzman Effect, and, unfortunately, not for his assistant, Norma Cenva, who actually discovered its use before Holtzman took over the project. This effect is used to



create a protective field of energy around a person. The shields quickly became commonly used for personal defense. While shields provide incredible protection, they allow slow-moving objects to pass through them—otherwise, the users would suffocate without atmospheric gasses such as oxygen. The evolution of the shields has allowed them to protect one side or one half of the body. To date, no one has been able to have the shields protect only a single limb or appendage.

Shields are affordable for most Houses and are commonplace with nobles and their retainers, with even some merchants able to have one. Holtzman shields are the primary reason for the move to more medieval forms of combat involving melee weapons. Their use on Arrakis is limited, as the vibration attracts the sandworms and puts them in a violent rage.

As an Asset: Shields are used for defense and can be used to threaten someone with a lasgun if activated.

Keywords: Atomic, Defense, Protection

Special: Ranged attacks cannot harm a character protected by a personal shield. If a shield is struck by a lasgun, either the shield or the lasgun (randomly determined) will produce an atomic explosion; using such methods of destruction upon a human population is strictly forbidden.

SHIELD, SEMI-

A variant of the personal shield, the semi-shield is a shield built to protect only a part of the body, usually the upper torso or half of the upper torso and one leg. Also called a half-shield. These are often used in gladiatorial games or with light sparring, where an additional level of skill is utilized to strike areas not covered by the semi-shield.

As an Asset: As with regular shields, semi-shields are used for defense and can be used to threaten someone with a lasgun if activated.

Keywords: Atomic, Defense, Protection

Special: It is more difficult to harm a character armed with a semi-shield with ranged combat, and special care must be taken to strike the portion not protected by the shield. In each case, the Difficulty is increased by +1 step. If a shield is struck by a lasgun, either the shield or the lasgun (randomly determined) will produce an atomic explosion; using such methods of destruction upon a human population is strictly forbidden.

As a semi-shield doesn't protect the whole body unlike most defensive assets it can be moved into any personal zone of the user as they shift position to make the best use of its protection.

STILLSUIT

These full-body suits are essential for survival on Arrakis outside the cities. Their primary function is to preserve the body's moisture by absorbing sweat, urine, and other

body fluids. The stillsuit processes these fluids by filtering impurities, recycling captured fluids into drinkable water collected in catchpockets, which is drunk through a tube. The key components of the stillsuit are filt-plug (collects moisture from exhaled air), faceflap (face mask that protects the wearer from fine dust), catchtube (connects the catchpockets), and stillsuit cap or hood.

As an Asset: An operable stillsuit allows the wearer to function for weeks in the desert by collecting water as it is lost by the body. Each stillsuit is finely-crafted, with multiple plated layers. The average stillsuit wearer loses 2.7 ml of water per day. Better Quality suits can reduce this.

Keywords: Arrakis, Fremen, Survival

PERSONAL ASSETS:

COMMUNICATION AND INFORMATION

COMMUNINET

The planetary universal system that connects communications.

As an Asset: Communinet is essential in relaying information on a universal scale. The communication system can be hacked and used as a weapon against other Houses.

Keywords: Communication, Information, Universal

DAMPER, IXIAN

The secrecy of the Ixians led to the creation of these devices to nullify eavesdroppers. These small tools usually cover a dome of roughly a 10-meter area. Larger Ixian dampers increase the dome's sphere of influence and counteract countermeasures.

As an Asset: The damper ensures the privacy of conversations (as a defensive asset against listening agents of devices). It can also be employed offensively if used while an opponent is attempting to communicate with distant allies.

Keywords: Countermeasure, Privacy, Technology

EMERGENCY TRANSMITTER

Emergency transmitters are small, coin-sized devices possessing limited range to alert others that the user needs help. The devices are frequently worn by nobles and high-ranking officials when they are in the field. More paranoid wearers always keep them on hand, with a security contingent ready to respond.

The signal is sent back to a relay station or communicator possessed by the reinforcements. The larger the relay station, the more range the signal has.

As an Asset: The emergency transmitter is a useful tool for alerting others or calling in reinforcements. Smaller

groups frequently carry multiple transmitters and receivers to minimize lack of communication.

Keywords: Communication, Concealable, Tiny

Special: Use of an emergency transmitter is often a good justification for creating assets that represent extra troops.

FILMBOOK

The filmbook is an imprint of shigawire that uses mnemonic pulses to train students. The exact subject varies per book, though shigawire is only found on Salusa Secundus and Ill Delta Kaising.

As an Asset: Noble Houses and other elite people use them for training their younger House and Guild members.

Keywords: Mnemonic, Shigawire, Training

MEMOCORDER

The technological masters of Ix built these tiny handheld black squares to store written messages. The originator writes a message on the square with a needle, one word on top of the next until the message is complete as the box absorbs each word. The message is read by nerve receptors, with the recipient seeing the message flash before their eyes.

As an Asset: The devices can only be cracked by extremely advanced technology.

Keywords: Infiltration, Secrecy, Technology

RIDULIAN CRYSTAL

Ridulian crystals redefined books, as each sheet of a page made of this crystal is only a few molecules thick. Due to the compressed state of the book, they can only be used with an automatic page-turner in the spine of the book.

A single volume of a book with an excess of thousands of pages would be a little over 1 cm thick.

As an Asset: A useful tool to convey large amounts of information without requiring much space to accommodate it. Also, for easy transport and disposal of the data if needed.

Keywords: Crystal, Knowledge, Skills

Quality: Special (the Quality depends on the contents of the book and the usefulness of the information it contains).

PERSONAL ASSETS: TOOLS AND PERSONAL EQUIPMENT

BARADYE PISTOL

Baradye pistols are produced on Arrakis by the Fremen to communicate. The pistol fires a static charge capable of turning a large, 20-meter-diameter area orange (or another color if programmed). The charge retains the

coloration for several hours before disappearing. The zone has many uses, from signaling traders or spice raiders to capturing sandworms.

As an Asset: The baradye pistol is a covert weapon useful in relaying messages and distracting others.

Keywords: Arrakis, Fremen, Signaling

CIBUS HOOD

A malleable, flexible black mask created by the Ixians. When placed over a wearer's face, it completely conceals all their features. The device does not emit any energy readings. When using the hood, the wearer appears as a regular person in passing and looks different when viewed a second or third time.

As an Asset: A cibus hood enables its user to easily escape notice and blend into crowds.

Keywords: Disguise, Infiltration, Technology

DEW COLLECTOR

These devices are commonly found on Arrakis. The dew collector is a small egg-shaped tool that collects the morning dew for later use.

As an Asset: Dew collectors are one of the ways to maintain life on the planet.

Keywords: Arrakis, Survival, Water

FREMKIT

A desert survival kit created by the Fremen. The kit has all the tools need to survive for roughly a month on Arrakis. It commonly includes a manual, paracompass, stilltent, maker hooks, emergency stillsuit patches, and thumper.

As an Asset: The kit's primary purpose is to allow someone to survive in the desert for a short period. The emergency stillsuit patches can be used to temporarily repair tears in a stillsuit for roughly a day.

Keywords: Desert, Fremen, Survival

GLOWGLOBE

These small devices use the Holtzman effect to hover near the user, providing illumination. The color of the light differs based on when it was constructed, and it is powered by an organic battery. They are easily switched on or off with a touch.

As an Asset: Glowglobes are used to illuminate areas of darkness, as distractions, and possibly as a concealable explosive delivery system.

Keywords: Hovering, Light

KRIMSKEL FIBER ROPE

Ecaz hufuf vine is woven together from strands to form Krimskel fiber. When pulled, the fiber will 'claw' itself together into a tighter and stronger compos-



ite. Attempting to escape being bound with the fiber instead reinforces the bonds.

As an Asset: A Krimskel fiber rope can be used to bind prisoners or even as a device to secure doors when tried to pull open.

Keywords: Capture, Prisoners, Utility

MAKER HOOKS

These narrow metallic shafts are used to open a gap within a sandworm's ring segments, exposing the less-armored hide beneath to the elements. Once pried open, the sandworm rolls onto its side to avoid sand getting in between the exposed flesh between the ring segments. This allows the user to get on top of the sandworm and guide the beast to wherever the rider wishes.

As an Asset: Maker hooks can be used to guide sandworms into enemy locations or travel great distances across Arrakis.

Keywords: Fremen, Sandworm, Transportation

PALM LOCK

These small-to-medium-sized locks are usable on objects up to the size of a warehouse door. Each lock is keyed to a specific person's palm or a genetic type (such as a Bene Gesserit). Anyone else must pick the lock to open it. Higher Quality locks are more challenging to pick.

As an Asset: A palm lock is a versatile tool to secure locks and can aid in escapes by locking a door while escaping.

Keywords: Encoded, Security, Tool

PARACOMPASS

The paracompass uses magnetic anomalies in a planet's magnetic field to determine directions by measuring instabilities. The device is a small handheld circular object that fits firmly in the palm.

As an Asset: Paracompasses are essential to locate directions and determine which way to travel in the wilds.

Keywords: Navigation, Survival

POISON SNOOPER

Poison has long been the preferred assassination method of nobles since Old Terra. It is hard to detect, difficult to identify who one's actual enemy is, and tougher still to prove who used it. Poisons typically come in two forms: food (chaumas) and drink (chaumurky). Countless deaths from poisoning led to the invention of poison snoopers that replaced food tasters. These mechanical devices scan edible substances before they are ingested. Both Ix and Richese are the primary manufacturers of poisons snoopers; however, the continued Ixian propaganda has most of the public believing their models are more sensitive.

Poison snoopers come in two forms. The first is a portable version that is a handheld box with an extendable hose that is placed over the substance. An alarm sounds if the snooper detects poison. More advanced models have the option to vibrate rather than emit an audible noise, facilitating concealed use. A larger form of poison snooper is installed on rooftops, usually above eating rooms, and is always active. Fixed alarms continuously emit an ear-piercing sound elevating in frequency every minute.

As an Asset: Poison snoopers are excellent for defense and for use in safeguarding endangered people.

Keywords: Detection, Security, Technology

Quality: To make matter easier the gamemaster may rule that a poison snooper automatically detects any poison asset in play of the same or lower Quality.

PROBE, IXIAN

A device wrought by the folk of Ix, the Ixian probe allows the user to scan and replicate the electrochemical signals in a human brain—living or dead—making a copy of personality traits, sense experience, and memory for later reference. The probe itself is a moderately-sized device, and requires sensors be attached to the intended subject, and an operator working while the process is ongoing.

The stored information is compiled into a simulacrum, a digital 'duplicate' of the original subject, which responds to stimulus in the same fashion, answering queries or providing answers. These simulacra are often disoriented, and if created without permission, can be angry and uncooperative. It is rumored that this technology allows Tleilaxu to create gholas, copies of living persons whose minds have been copied with Ixian probes.

Note that the simulacrum is not a thinking machine in and of itself but is in fact merely a means of recovering information and responses. Simulacra are necessarily limited in their ability to have original thoughts and to learn, unable to form neural pathways that duplicate human learning and actual cognitive development. Many within the Imperium feel that the distinction is irrelevant, and that the device skirts the limits of what is allowed under the Butlerian Edicts. Due to its immense potential for espionage, the Ixian probe is considered a loathsome innovation to most civilized people and is not generally used, even by the most amoral of spymasters.

The most reliable means of circumventing duplication by an Ixian probe is consuming a drug called *shere*, which disrupts the probe's ability to collect information, rendering the data useless. Upon death, *shere* also causes rapid deterioration of the nervous system of the one who took it, rendering all further attempts impossible. *Shere* has no other practical applications and due to its side effects, is not commonly used as a precaution, despite its efficacy.

A later innovation, the T-Probe, is able to copy the memories of a person even if they have consumed *shere*, but causes incredible, frequently lethal amounts of pain to its subject.

As an Asset: An Ixian probe can copy a living or recently-deceased human being and allow access to a digital simulacrum of them, as if speaking to them in person.

Keywords: Ixian, Knowledge, Secret Information, Technology,

SAPHO

A juice created from the roots of plants on the planet Ecaz. The juice is refined into a high-energy drink that amplifies mental powers.

As an Asset: Sapho is addictive if used repeatedly and leaves tell-tale signs by staining one's mouth and lips a ruby color. It is favored by Mentats.

Keywords: Addictive, Mentat, Stimulant

STILLTENT

This airtight tent works similar to the stillsuit by capturing the humidity inside of it and gathering it for use by the tenant. These are frequently used under a layer or two of sand. The tents use sandsnorks (installed air tubes) to provide air to the interior of the tent.

As an Asset: Stilltents are essential for traveling on the surface of Arrakis and are commonly used by Fremen.

Keywords: Fremen, Sealed, Survival

SUSPENSOR, PERSONAL

Personal suspensors are frequently placed into belts, chairs, and other portable objects. These devices operate on the secondary (low drain) phase of the Holtzman field generator and nullify local gravity. The height and mass of the energy consumed is based on the weight of the object lifted. Personal suspensors do not have the power to allow flight or stop falls from very high distances before running out of power. This application of the field was pioneered by Norma Cenva in the creation of the glowglobes during her tenure working for Tio Holtzman.

As an Asset: Personal suspensors can be used as transportation, for carrying heavy objects, or moving large forms of ordinance.

Keywords: Anti-gravity, Holtzman, Mobility

THUMPER

A simple device used to summon sandworms on Arrakis. The thumper is composed of a spring-loaded clapper on a short stake that repeatedly strikes the ground. Delayed thumpers exist which have a candle attached to them that burns for one hour before activating the thumper. Longer candles can be used to extend the duration, with an increased chance of failure for each additional fifteen minutes.

As an Asset: The thumper is useful in calling or distracting sandworms. The device can be used to cause mass destruction by having the sandworm appear in an area.

Keywords: Arrakis, Sandworm

ATOMICS & THE GREAT CONVENTION

The Great Convention is the rules of warfare laid out by the Emperor and Landsraad over a millennium ago that all Houses must follow on pain of destruction. The use of atomic weaponry against humans, or the firing of a lasgun against shielded targets (which results in a pseudo-atomic explosion), is outlawed. All Houses have access to atomics, but they do not use them for such.

WARFARE ASSETS

Warfare on Arrakis has little resemblance to warfare on nearly any other planet in the Imperium. Everywhere in the Imperium shields are ubiquitous, cheap, and easy to produce, and have been common for over a thousand years. Thus, ranged warfare as was commonly practiced throughout history is nearly extinct.

Military units of the Houses of the Landsraad use ranged weapons almost exclusively against unshielded rebellious and riotous commoner populations. Soldiers without shields are utterly outclassed at every turn and can be easily destroyed by shielded infantry. Thus, ranged military tactics like enfilading fire, covering fire, bounding overwatch, air support, missile and bombing attacks of entrenched positions, and other tactics or strategies have almost disappeared.

Warfare between the Houses, in most of the Imperium, involves little to no space combat, as the Spacing Guild severely restricts such warfare in fear of damaging their precious Heighliners. It does, however, involve large units of shielded and melee-armed foot soldiers being transported to and from strategic locations by massive shielded transports. Troops then fight in largely melee formations to wrest control of these locations from the defenders, who are also shielded melee troops. Shielded ornithopters are used as scouts to follow and observe the movements of troops and transports and report said intelligence to command. Strategic locations themselves are shielded to prevent artillery strikes or bombardment.

Conversely, on Arrakis, shield technology is difficult to use, as shields of any size attract the attention of enraged sandworms, and the weather conditions of constant dust particles, frequent sandstorms, and high static electricity make shields unreliable and difficult to maintain. As has often been the case, militaries deployed upon Arrakis are slow to adapt and learn how to fight on the planet. Of course, the planet's long-time inhabitants, the Fremen, have adapted to their terrain and learned effective tactics and strategies, and learned how to fight asymmetrical wars against standing militaries.

WARFARE ASSETS:

SHIELDS & EMBLEMMENTS

STRATEGIC/HOUSE SHIELD

Strategic or House Holtzman shields, which derive their name from the Holtzman effect, are large shields that project an energy field around strategic sites. Personal shields also exist, but they cannot begin to compare to the strength of these massive defenses that would require energy levels like that of a crashing spaceship, comet, or meteorite to cause the shield to fail. They are used to defend massive fortresses and small cities from all forms of high-speed projectiles, from bombardments down to small arms fire.

As an Asset: A shield is a House-level asset whose control can change the tide of a battle. Widely used throughout the Imperium, on Arrakis they are only used within the Imperial Basin, as sandworms are not found there; if used elsewhere on the planet, sandworms would be attracted to their vibrations and attack.

Keywords: Atomic, Impenetrable, Strategic

FORTRESS

Because they can be defended by strategic shields, fortified locations like castles and fortresses—places that rely on defensive architecture designed to impede melee armed ground troops—have become the standard form of defense of strategic locations throughout the Imperium and even on Arrakis. On Arrakis, only the Imperial Basin combines fortresses with shields, but the various Fremen sietches throughout the planet are also fortified against both conventional and nonconventional attacks.

As an Asset: Another strategic asset, fortresses and their control play a major role in who controls a planet, and who can lay claim to ownership of a territory in front of the Landsraad and the Emperor. They are designed to impede and kill attackers while still allowing access for regular business during peaceful times.

Keywords: Defensive, Heavy Cover, Strategic

BUNKER

Bunkers, pillboxes, entrenched positions, or any sort of fortified location, shielded or not, are smaller defensive structures intended to slow or stop attackers. They are smaller than fortresses and can be created quickly with an entrenching tool. At times, more complex permanent bunkers are built in a place too small to secure with a full-sized fortress—for example, at a bridge with limited banks on either side suitable for construction. Bunkers are also used to defend temporary systems like undermining operations designed to penetrate shielded fortresses from below the ground.

WORMSIGN!

The danger to spice production notwithstanding, war and large scale combat on Arrakis is exceptionally difficult. Heavy tracked vehicles and the recoil of large ordinance create tremors and vibrations that the great sandworms can feel from miles away. This is to say nothing of shields, which enrage the worms and make them attack. The worms are among the most deadly things on Arrakis, and while the Houses have many powerful weapons, few can swallow an entire army whole.

As an Asset: A bunker is a tactical asset used to secure and give a bonus to defensive units and characters. It defends a smaller but critical location, like the only bridge that crosses a river for miles, or temporary defenses built to hold difficult ground recently won in a battle.

Keywords: Defensive, Heavy Cover, Tactical

WARFARE ASSETS:

SOLDIER

CONSCRIPT

Conscripts are the lowest of the low. Soldiers assembled with little to no training and bad or non-existent equipment. They almost never have shields and are armed with a combination of ranged weapons and shoddy melee weapons. These soldiers could be used to represent rebelling peasants, escaped slaves, or conscripted prisoners meant to tie up enemy forces while other soldiers maneuver into flanking positions.

As an Asset: Used to distract, hinder, or slow down an enemy force, or to attack unprepared enemy locations only defended by noncombatants.

Keywords (choose three): Expendable, Poor Training, Ranged Weapons, or Unshielded

Quality: 0 (larger units may have higher Quality).

SHIELD INFANTRY

These are the standard line infantry used throughout the Imperium: shielded soldiers armed with melee weapons and trained to fight efficiently in large formations of a thousand men or more. They learn how to defend quickly and attack slowly, move in formation together, and pin and flank other formations.

As an Asset: This asset represents a trained unit from a small squad up to a large brigade of soldiers.

Keywords: Formation, Melee Weapons, Shielded

Quality: 1 (larger units may have higher Quality).

SPECIALIST

Specialist troops represent any unit of soldiers not meant for main line combat. Engineers, sappers, military police/security, technicians, mechanics, special operations, drivers, scouts, or even a squadron of pilots without their 'thopters are all military specialists who don't usually fight on the front lines of conventional Imperium battles.

As an Asset: This usually represents a standard unit of specialist soldiers large enough to complete their usual specialty task. Designate what their specialty trait is when they are acquired.

Keywords: Shielded, Special Equipment: _____, Specialty: _____, or Well-armed

Quality: 2 (larger numbers may increase Quality)

ELITE TROOP

The elite House guard of the Great Houses of the Landsraad. Most of these units are a small elite force meant as an honor guard or security detail to defend the ruler and their immediate family. However, some powerful military-minded Houses may have entire regiments. The Imperial Sardaukar are one such army, and the Fremen Fedaykin are another.

As an Asset: This unit represents a generic elite guard of soldiers who have sworn an oath to defend their lieges unto death. They receive all the best training, equipment, and benefits of any soldiers.

Keywords: Elite Morale, Formation, Melee Weapons, Shielded

Quality: 3–4

ELITE TROOPS: FEDAYKIN

Fremen death commandos. These warriors swear blood oaths to Muad'dib and are some of the toughest warriors in the Imperium.

Keywords: Crysknives, Death Commandos, Desert Power, Guerillas

Quality: 4

ELITE TROOPS: SARDAUKAR

The Emperor's elite guard and personal army. These soldiers were raised on the harsh planet of Salusa Secundus, where more than half die before reaching adulthood and completing their training. Only the Fedaykin can rival their fighting ability.

Keywords: Brutal, Elite Morale, Elite Training, Feared, Formation, Melee Weapons, Shielded,

Quality: 4



WARFARE ASSETS: TRANSPORTS

PERSONNEL CARRIER

These massive shielded vehicles are designed to ferry troops across planetary surfaces and are as varied and unique as the planets they are designed to traverse. Most are wheel-based, although walkers, treaded, and even anti-gravity variants are not uncommon. These also range in size from squad-based carriers to massive shielded land ships that carry companies or even a full regiment of soldiers.

As an Asset: A fleet of these vehicles is usually maintained by a House so that they can transport troops quickly to various strategic places within their territory. Smaller vehicles are more common.

Keywords: All-terrain, Shielded, Troop Transport

Quality: Larger carriers carry more troops

ANTI-GRAV PLATFORM

Not originally a weapon of war, anti-gravity platforms, or just grav platforms, were adopted centuries ago into modern Imperial warfare. Most are shielded like personnel carriers, but their grav systems allow them to be used as ways to overcome fortress walls, deliver troops in tight spaces, work as elevators along unprepared cliff faces, or ferry people and equipment across rivers or other impassable terrain. These vary in size, but most are designed to comfortably carry an entire squad of soldiers, their equipment, and a pilot/operator. As they

incorporate a Holtzman effect to function, they are rare on Arrakis, although Glossu Rabban Harkonnen used one as bait when he hunted a sandworm.

As an Asset: These can be used as short-range transportation for troops or other supplies, and often are little more than a platform built with a shield, anti-gravity generators, and a control console.

Keywords: Anti-gravity, Flatbed, Shielded

NAVAL TRANSPORT

Naval transports carry troops and supplies across large bodies of water or up rivers at times when traveling by air or orbital transports would be strategically unsound. These ships have changed little from the eras before humanity took the stars. The major difference is the inclusion of a shield to discourage attacks. They can range from small patrol boats to massive cargo transports designed to carry tens of thousands of troops.

As an Asset: These can be used as waterborne transportation for troops or other supplies when air or orbital travel is unwise or prohibited.

Keywords: Naval, Shielded

ORNITHOPTER

These advanced flying machines use huge wings to fly like dragonflies. This allows them to take off and land vertically and glide to preserve fuel. They are quiet in flight and far less polluting than a traditional jet engine. It also makes them incredibly agile. Many versions of ornithopter exist, from small one- or two-person craft to



massive cargo aircraft able to carry troops or supplies. In the case of larger ornithopters, jet engines may be deployed to assist with speed and lift.

As an Asset: Ornithopters can be used to gather intelligence in warfare as well as move troops and attack both air and ground targets. As espionage devices they allow quiet observation of a target as well as providing a fast and subtle way to escape an area. An exceptionally lavish personal ornithopter might even grant some social status. On Arrakis, they fill an expanded role beyond just recon and transport. They can be armed with guns, rockets, and missiles to work as close air support and air superiority, weather permitting.

Keywords (grouped by variant):

- ❖ **Scout:** Fast, Flying, Glide, Quiet, Size: Small
- ❖ **Troop Transport:** Fast, Flying, Glide, Quiet, Size: Squad
- ❖ **Supply Carrier:** Fast, Flying, Glide, Jet-assisted, Size: Company
- ❖ **Attack/Arrakis:** Fast, Flying, Glide, Guns, Missiles, Quiet, Rockets, Size: Small

CARRYALL

Most often seen as air transport for spice harvesters on Arrakis, carryalls are the air transportation workhorse of the Imperium military and civilian sectors. These massive craft, essentially large-scale ornithopters, use a variety of flight systems—from modified ornithopter wings, to jet, rocket, and anti-gravity systems—to quickly travel across the skies of the planets of the Imperium. Designs of carryalls vary based on their intended cargo. Personnel carryalls appear much like massed civilian air transports. Internal cargo carryalls have similar but bulkier builds compared to personnel carryalls, while external cargo carryalls, like the ones used on Arrakis to pick up and transport spice harvesters, appear to be not much more than a large frame with flight systems attached and various cargo clamps for holding the specialty cargo during transport. Cargo carryalls as used in spice mining usually have room for only four crew: two pilots and two journeymen attachers.

As an Asset: Depending on the design of a carryall, they excel at transporting cargo or personnel across planets at suborbital altitudes. These workhorses are employed by spice smugglers on Arrakis to quickly come and go from illicit spice harvesting operations in the deep deserts.

Keywords: Cargo Space, Flying, Shielded, Size: Large to Gargantuan

WARFARE ASSETS:

ARTILLERY & ANTI-AIRCRAFT

ARTILLERY

Artillery guns are massive cannons, often mounted on a vehicle platform, that fire explosive shells over kilometers to soften up unshielded infantry and fortified positions. Nearly obsolete, artillery is only employed in the rare instances when a military force is fighting against unshielded rebels or on Arrakis, where the inability to use shields on most of the planet makes their use a viable military strategy.

As an Asset: These guns need to be crewed by a group of soldiers trained in their use, but if this is done they are very effective and can deploy a variety of warheads from air-burst and explosive rounds designed to eviscerate unshielded soldiers, to armor-piercing, bunker buster, and even gas and toxin shells that can spread deadly pathogens or poisonous gases across the battlefield.

Keywords: Crew-served, Long-ranged, Shell Varieties

ROCKET/MISSILE LAUNCHER

Rocket and missile launchers range from one-man disposable rocket-propelled grenades to large vehicle-driven systems designed to launch masses of 'dumb' rockets or guided missiles at a variety of unshielded targets. Guided missile systems are also deployed in anti-aircraft roles. Much like artillery, rocket and missile launchers have nearly gone extinct with the widespread adoption of shields. However, they continue to be of use on Arrakis and against unshielded targets on other planets.

As an Asset: These have been used to great success by various factions on Arrakis over the centuries. Fremen employ rocket-propelled grenades during raids targeting spice harvesters and other vulnerable targets. The Harkonnen effectively used rocket and missile launchers against the Atrides when they seized power on Arrakis.

Keywords (grouped by variant):

- ❖ **RPG:** Armor-piercing, Explosive, Portable, Single-use, Unguided
- ❖ **MPAD:** Anti-aircraft, Armor-piercing, Explosive, Guided, Portable, Single-use
- ❖ **Mortar:** Anti-personnel, Arcing Fire, Armor-piercing, Explosive, Two-person Crew
- ❖ **Rocket Launcher:** Arcing, Armor-piercing, Explosive, Ground Vehicle, Mass Fire, Unguided
- ❖ **Missile Launcher:** Anti-aircraft, Armor-piercing, Explosive, Ground Vehicle, Guided, Mass Fire

ORNITHOPERS & SHIELDS

In general, anything can be shielded, as the generators required to create the field scale to the size of the object. A fortress requires a large shield generator, but a personal shield can be generated from a belt pack. However, ornithopters are more difficult as their wide wingspan compared to their size means their shield generator needs to be much larger and heavier than it would for a different vehicle of that size. So, in general, ornithopters don't carry shields.

However, few nobles are comfortable traveling in an unshielded vehicle. Some few are installed with heavy shield generators for the protection of important passengers. This cumbersome extra weight is a reason why many owners forgo installing shield generators on their ornithopters, as they are unwilling to sacrifice maneuverability and speed for additional safety.

An ornithopter may replace their Fast keyword with the Shielded keyword.

WARFARE ASSETS:

OTHER VEHICLES

A large number and variety of other craft exist, but most are never seen during warfare. However, because of their strategic importance three such vehicles may be found at the center of a furious battle for control. Therefore, to provide some context we have detailed them here.

SPICE HARVESTER

The literal factory that supplies the source of Imperial power, spice harvesters are massive mobile mining and refining factories. They are crewed by daring wildcat crews who work furiously to harvest as much spice as possible from spice blows before a sandworm appears. Sandworms always appear as they are drawn to the vibrations of the harvesters. Designs vary, but they are often described as massive beetle-like ground vehicles that are flown into place by a carryall. During a short period of time they send out scout vehicles to search for the incoming worm while drills and scoops extend to draw the spice into the harvester to begin the refining process.

As an Asset: The rulers of Arrakis are nominally the only ones who control spice harvesters, but smugglers and the Fremen employ their own. The Fremen, Imperial-backed rulers, and the smugglers wage an ongoing shadow war, striking at their opponents' spice harvesters whenever they see an opportunity. Thus, they are not infrequently found in the middle of a pitched battle.

Keywords: Designed for Carryall Transport, Factory, Integral Scout Vehicles, Massive, Spice-infused, Wormcall

ORBITAL TRANSPORT

To reach Spacing Guild Heighliners, the Spacing Guild has countless large craft that travel to and from orbital space. Each Guild craft can carry thousands of individuals and millions of tons of goods for planetary markets and exchanges. Some Landsraad Houses own their own orbital transports and prefer to stay aboard their own transports for security and comfort reasons, and these craft vary in size from single- or two-person affairs up to the size of Guild craft. Incidents in space are almost unheard of because of the

prohibitions placed on space warfare by the Spacing Guild; although rare events do happen, they are generally limited. More frequently, transports may find themselves engulfed in a mobile battle when landed near a strategic location, or when unloading troops transported to a planet.

As an Asset: As with the spice-harvester, these transports are more strategic targets than tools or weapons in their own right. However, cunning characters like Baron Harkonnen have discovered ways to employ them as weapons.

Keywords: Cargo, Guild/House Design, Shielded, Spacecraft, Staterooms

HEIGHLINER

The Imperium exists because of spice and the Holtzman engine. The engine makes instantaneous jumps from one location in space to another by folding the space in between. The spice allows Spacing Guild Navigators and Steersmen to navigate this jump through space while controlling moon-like spacecraft called Heighliners. These immense craft often reach 20 kilometers in length and can house hundreds of orbital transports of all sizes at any one time. Each day multiple Heighliners travel routes to every planet of the Empire to keep trade flowing throughout. With one of these ships one could easily find themselves halfway across the Empire in a day.

As an Asset: To wrest control of a Heighliner from the Spacing Guild would be to commit one of the highest crimes against the Empire, and one would need to control the specialized and mutated Navigator to even transport the ship anywhere else. But stranger things have happened.

Keywords: Carrier, FTL Travel, Immense, Navigator Pilot Required, Spacecraft

ESPIONAGE ASSETS

WAR OF ASSASSINS AND KANLY

Conflict between Houses is inevitable. To ensure minimal collateral damage during a clash between members of the Landsraad, a House can declare a War of Assassins. Sanctioned under the Great Convention and the Guild Peace, a War of Assassins allows Houses to battle each other by following a series of strict rules and using only allowed weaponry as described in the *Assassins' Handbook*. Dartguns and hunter-seekers are some examples of permitted tools in this narrow definition of warfare.

Though like a War of Assassins, kanly is less an armed struggle between Houses and more like the single combat duels of the distant past. Kanly negotiations—overseen by an appointed Judge of the Change—or kanly challenges must follow the edicts of the Great Convention. The results of kanly are final and can determine the fate of a House.

ESPIONAGE ASSETS:

WEAPONS

DARTGUN

The Assassins' Handbook sings the praises of the humble dartgun. With its small, inconspicuous rounds coated in War of Assassins-approved poisons, this small weapon is a choice instrument for enacting political and diplomatic change among the Landsraad. Compact and easily hidden, dartguns make for versatile tools.

As an Asset: As they fit into the palm of a hand, up a sleeve, or under a jacket, dartguns make for excellent, unobtrusive defensive weapons... or tools for assassination. Coating the darts with a variety of drugs and poisons can provide a wide arsenal of options for employing these handy pieces of equipment.

Keywords: Ranged Weapon, Quiet, Small

FLIP-DART

Tiny and discreet, the flip-dart is named for the flip-cover that hides its sharp barb. The Emperor's elite Sardaukar often carry a flip-dart concealed on them. With the drug- or poison-covered needle hidden among their jewelry or uniforms, Sardaukar use the flip-darts in hand-to-hand combat to provide an arguably unfair advantage.

As an Asset: Because they are so easy to disguise, flip-darts work well for both offense and defense. These small weapons are incredibly versatile thanks to the huge number of poisons and drugs available to coat their small needles. Some spies rely on these to deliver antidotes or to prevent themselves or others from talking under interrogation.

Keywords: Melee Weapon, Quiet, Tiny

HUNTER-SEEKER

When stealth and anonymity is paramount, assassins employ hunter-seekers. As small as five centimeters, these compact devices float using a suspensor. Due to the universal prohibition on thinking machines, a hunter-seeker requires a nearby operator to control it, and due to limited visibility are difficult to use against immobile targets. These *Assassins' Handbook*-approved instruments tunnel through skin and muscle to destroy hearts, brains, and other vital organs. Noble children learn to identify these weapons early on in their lives, and how to avoid them by standing resolutely still.

As an Asset: Hunter-seekers are brutal and effective weapons of assassination. However, they require a traitor or an infiltrator on the inside to guide the device. Blackmail victims, fanatic loyalists, or highly paid mercenaries all make for good operators.

Keywords: Remote-operated, Short-ranged, Stealthy

POISONED TOOTH

Designed to look like a tooth, a poisoned tooth can even fool poison snoopers and scanners. Only a close, thorough examination will reveal its true nature. These weapons are deadly to the target and whoever carries the tooth in their mouth. Biting down on this instrument of doom crushes the brittle, fake enamel and activates the nerve-shaped tablet within, resulting in a cloud of poison gas that surrounds the tooth's bearer and any in the immediate area.

As an Asset: The poisoned tooth is an option of last resort. It's not unusual for spies to have one in their mouths when on missions to avoid capture or interrogation. They've also been used in attempted assassinations when the assassin knows they will get near the target and does not plan on surviving the encounter.

Keywords: Last Resort, Stealthy, Toxic



SHIGAWIRE GARROTE

Shigawire comes from the *Narvi narvium* ground vine found on Salusa Secundus and III Delta Kaising. Its primary use is in holding and transmitting messages. However, the Sardaukar were the first ones to use the strong, thin filaments as garrotes. They now carry them as standard issue, often blended into one's hair or concealed elsewhere.

As an Asset: Shigawire isn't hard to find in the Imperium, considering its varied uses in communications. If an individual wants one for offense or defense, it's almost always close at hand. That also means that an opponent has easy access, as well.

Keywords: Common, Melee Weapon, Subtle

SLIP-TIP

A slip-tip can render even the strongest opponent powerless just by scratching the skin. This weapon emerged from the world of shield-fighting, where combatants carry blades in both hands. In a traditional match, the slip-tip is the shorter, poison-coated blade held in the left hand. Those who use them outside the shield-fighting arena are usually making a statement by using the archaic weapons.

As an Asset: Though these blades have a long-established history in the Imperium and originated from ritual

combat, some with dangerous intent carry them in day-to-day life. Depending on the poisons chosen, these thin blades can result in a quick, quiet death or a long, torturous one.

Keywords: Archaic, Melee Weapon, Small

ESPIONAGE ASSETS: DRUGS

CHAUMAS AND CHAUMURKY

Poisoning a friend, foe, or family member through food and drink is a time-honored practice in the Imperium. Chaumas refers to poison administered through comestibles, while chaumurky is the category of poisoned beverages. These terms include both fast-acting and slow-acting poisons.

As an Asset: Those who are members of the Landsraad are wary of both chaumas and chaumurky and make liberal use of poison snoopers. Those who implement chaumas and chaumurky often need to find ways to avoid poison snoopers and the various methods of scanning for and identifying different poisons.

Keywords: Expensive, Ingestible, Stealthy

ELACCA

On Ecaz, a planet in Alpha Centauri B, they burn elacca wood to create this potent narcotic. It sends users into an intense rage that suppresses an individual's survival instincts and changes their skin to a peculiar carrot-colored hue. Few in the Imperium choose to take this drug of their own free will. The most common application of this narcotic is in drugging slave-combatants for the gladiatorial arenas. However, some soldiers do choose to ingest it before a battle to harden their resolve.

As an Asset: Despite the Imperium generally frowning on the practice, some commanders have dosed their troops to eliminate the risk of desertion before or during an engagement. Some also suggest using it to send an unsuspecting individual on a rampage against a target to deflect suspicion. In the past, unwittingly drugged victims died at the hands of those defending themselves against elacca-enraged individuals.

Keywords: Bloodlust, Drug, Inexpensive, Orange-tinged Skin

RESIDUAL POISON

The twisted Mentat Piter de Vries created a system of dependence in which an individual must receive periodic antidotes or the poison coursing through their body will kill them over time. The victim may or may not know about the death waiting for them. This is a savage, but effective, method of control.

As an Asset: Residual poison may be used as blackmail or a failsafe. The victim may act out of character to make sure they get their antidotes on time. A victim who doesn't know about the residual poison may simply not receive the antidote when their usefulness runs out.

Keywords: Drug, Expensive, Unobtrusive

SEMUTA

Ecaz's valuable elacca tree also produces semuta, a highly addictive narcotic. As opposed to the frenzy that the elacca drug causes in its users, semuta evokes a euphoric bliss when paired with atonal semuta music. A semuta user can counteract the effects with an antidote.

As an Asset: Many choose to use semuta as a way to relax. However, others take advantage of the associated addiction as a means of manipulating others through blackmail, withholding the drug, or offering copious amounts of the narcotic to an addict. Having a steady, reliable supply can lead to extreme loyalty. Semuta is also a popular currency for bribery.

Keywords: Addictive, Euphoric, Expensive, Ingestible

SHERE

A drug taken by anyone fearing that they will be subjected to an Ixian probe (see p.199). This obscures the neural processes that the probe reads, making collection and dupli-

cation of the subject's thoughts, memories, and emotions impossible. Upon death, a subject using shere suffers rapid neural disintegration, eliminating any possibility of future copying. The risk of side effects such as nerve damage make taking this drug a substance of last resort.

As an Asset: A subject that has consumed shere is immune to the effects of an Ixian probe while alive or dead. The later T-Probe, however, is unhindered by the drug.

Keywords: Expensive, Ingestive, Obscuring, Uncommon

TRUTHSAYER DRUG

By falling into a truthtrance, some remarkable Bene Gesserit Reverend Mothers have the ability to distinguish truth from falsehood in even the most practiced liars. Though not all Reverend Mothers need them, truthsayer drugs allow them to enter the truthtrance. Without the control afforded by prana-bindu training, anyone lacking the conditioning of the Bene Gesserit taking a truthsayer drug dies a painful death.

As an Asset: For those possessing both the confidence to believe themselves exceptional and the desire to practice the mystical Bene Gesserit arts, the truthsayer drugs are a powerful temptation. As such, the truthsayer drugs can be used as currency, poison, or on a Bene Gesserit who can enter the truthtrance.

Keywords: Expensive, Ingestible, Poisonous, Spice-derived

VERITE

Yet another specialty product of Ecaz, verite is a plant that grows on only that planet. After a specific processing technique, it becomes a narcotic. Verite smashes through a user's willpower, compelling them to tell the truth. It is impossible to resist.

Asset: Verite is a viable alternative to a Bene Gesserit Truthsayer. This narcotic is also an effective interrogation tactic or an intelligence-gathering tool for dosed unknowingly.

Keywords: Expensive, Ingestible, Narcotic

ESPIONAGE ASSETS:

COMMUNICATION

BENE GESSERIT CODED DOTS

To communicate with each other in secret, the Bene Gesserit developed a system of raised or engraved dots that can be left on almost any surface. Sisters can hide messages for each other in unexpected places that even skilled spies won't find. To read the intelligence left for her, a Bene Gesserit Sister runs her fingertips along the dots.

As an Asset: Knowing how to read Bene Gesserit coded dots gives an individual the ability to gather information not meant for them. They can also leave messages for a Bene Gesserit Sister... and possibly send a Sister on the wrong path with deliberate misinformation.

Keywords: Bene Gesserit, Stealthy, Uncommon

DISTRANS

While the specific technology varies by planet and subject, distrans enable a user to implant information in an animal and turn it into an unknown accomplice in conveying messages. The recipient of the animal retrieves the message by using a code. The animal relays the message through chirps, screeches, and other noises that approximate words.

Birds are frequently used as couriers, with bats being the most sought after for their nocturnal abilities.

As an Asset: Distrans ensure private and secure communication.

Keywords: Animal, Courier, Stealth

INTELLIGENCE

Illicit information comes in many forms in the Imperium. Tiny minimic films made from shigawire, Bene Gesserit coded dots, decoders, intercepted communications, spy-eyes, spies, and traitors can all provide different insights into the trundling gears of the Imperium. Ixian dampers and cones of silence exist in the Imperium for good reason. Trust no one.

As an Asset: Intelligence gathering goes both ways. Those searching for secrets might be giving away valuable details themselves.

Keywords: Secret Information

INTERROGATION

The Harkonnens in particular are known for their success in wringing intelligence out of unwilling captives. Torture, verite, and all manner of brutal methods are common and accepted in the Imperium.

As an Asset: Interrogation is effective. Using it or resisting it will require mental, physical, and spiritual fortitude.

Keywords: Secret Information

MAP

Guild bribery, intentional deceit, financial dishonesty, and geographical fraud all contribute to flawed or incomplete maps of the various planets and systems within the Imperium. Accurate maps are helpful for survival and planning but finding them is not always easy. Many Houses and communities have their reasons to hide this kind of information.

As an Asset: A reliable map can reveal a lot about a planet, the people, and the local Houses... and what they're hiding. Resources, weapons, technology, warehouses, or sweeping changes to a planet's environment might all be things that different factions want to keep to themselves.

Keywords: Secret information

SHIGAWIRE

An organic product of the Narvi narvium ground vine found on Salusa Secundus and III Delta Kaising, shigawire is critical for communication across the Imperium. Though the

Sardaukar sometimes use the strong, thin wire as a garrote, it's more often found in recording and transmitting devices. Tiny, unobtrusive minimic films and the mnemonic pulse-imprinted filmbooks are two common uses of this vine.

As an Asset: Minimic films are only one micron in diameter, making them easy to smuggle and hide. Encrypted shigawire reels also act as ways to send messages.

Keywords: Common, Inexpensive, Physical Item

ESPIONAGE ASSETS:

CONTACTS AND AGENTS

ASSASSIN

Knowledgeable in the rules, regulations, and permissible techniques from the *Assassins' Handbook*, assassins are not rogue actors working outside the system but rather a critical part of how the Imperium functions. By adhering to the restrictions set out in the War of Assassins under the Great Convention and Guild Peace, assassins help to keep warfare between the Houses of the Landsraad civil... or at least with minimal civilian casualties. Assassins are clever, dangerous, and often placed in positions of power within the Great Houses.

As an Asset: An assassin has certain skills and an understanding of how society works that not all are privy to. They're a good friend to have and a cruel foe to face. With their contacts spread among the underbelly of the Imperium as well as the highest ranks of nobility, they often have intelligence others don't.

Keywords: Cunning, Dangerous, Elusive

CORPORATE SPY

House Vernius, House Harkonnen, and others all have large organizations that they run. They provide technology, weapons, and other resources to the rest of the Imperium. Many Houses also have shares in the Empire-wide economic syndicate CHOAM, the Combine Honnete Ober Advancer Mercantiles. As a result, many Houses, CHOAM itself, the Bene Gesserit, and other factions throughout the Imperium have embedded spies throughout these institutions.

As an Asset: Spies may know about, or know how to find, secret schematics, exclusive technology, confidential formulas, and other valuable information. They may also have access to sensitive details about their employers, giving anyone who gets their hands on a spy the chance to turn the tables on a rival.

Keywords: Elusive, Knowledgeable

FACE DANCER

These genetically-engineered humanoids cultivated by the Bene Tleilax are unrivaled in the arena of spycraft. With their ability to change their appearance and even secondary sex characteristics, Face Dancers can mimic their

targets to an almost undetectable degree. If a Face Dancer has infiltrated an organization, they may be almost impossible to root out. This gives the Bene Tleilax incredible power in the Imperium, despite the general disdain toward them as a people.

As an Asset: Face Dancers can sneak into almost any location, organization, or government without notice. However, they are programmed with loyalty to the Bene Tleilax, so turning one against their masters or toward independence is not a simple task. Their devotion to their Bene Tleilax masters may become a liability in the field. A Face Dancer may also come to believe that they are the person whose life they assumed, if left in place for too long, and in some cases can break free of their Tleilaxu masters.

Keywords: Elusive, Genetically Programmed, Indistinguishable

MENTAT MASTER OF ASSASSINS

After the ban on thinking machines in the Imperium, Mentats (or 'human computers') took over the assessment and forecasting tasks that the thinking machines once performed. Mentats are often trained to fight and kill as well. The title Master of Assassins goes to the Mentat who serves a House Major. They mastermind the strategies in a War of Assassins against and for their House. Houses place a high value on their Masters of Assassins.

As an Asset: Mentats have incredible abilities that allow them to evaluate situations while considering vast amounts of data. They can often predict upcoming offensives and determine the best course of action for their Houses. A Mentat Master of Assassins is a dangerous and clever opponent.

Keywords: Human Computer, Intelligent, Tricky

POLITICAL SPY

The Landsraad represents all the Houses Major and Minor in the Imperium but is only one of its ruling bodies. With so many different parts to the Imperium affecting wide-ranging policy, political spies are rampant. Many Houses try to infiltrate the Padishah Emperor's own government. Others attempt to blackmail rival or lesser Houses with the information they gather. For a member of a House, it is difficult to determine who to trust even within one's own family.

As an Asset: A political spy can provide information on a War of Assassins, blackmail material, or plans for Landsraad proposals. Catching a spy can result in new information about a known enemy or an unknown adversary. Protecting one's spies and defending against hostile spies is a never-ending battle for the Houses of the Imperium.

Keywords: Elusive, Knowledgeable, Tricky



INTRIGUE ASSETS

INTRIGUE ASSETS: FAVORS

Favors are the kind of resource which the best agents of a House utilize as often as they can, but they must be used with care. Failing to maintain a cover or pushing a selected asset too hard can lead to exposure and catastrophe. After all, if an asset feels themselves to have been betrayed, their trust broken and their friendship (or more) discarded, they are likely to seek vengeance. Intrigue and political chicanery are always dangerous games, and while favors can certainly be the most subtle of all approaches, this must be balanced with their potential for disaster. It requires perspicacity and nerve to achieve successfully. But a favor owed by the right person to the right agent can change the fate of a House, or Arrakis, forever...

DEBTOR

Someone owes you. Whether it is cash, drugs, or whatever they have borrowed from you in some way. When needed, you can call in that debt and force them to provide you with something in return. You can do this gradually, always insinuating that the loan you extended to them is about to be withdrawn, or you can do it suddenly, demanding payment now! Of course, as necessary as this might be, it tends to cost an agent their asset. Once burned, or once the favor has been called in and revealed to be a quid pro quo, the relationship between the agent and their asset is usually done. Burned. In a few cases, with the most subtle and most expert of agents—those with Mentat training perhaps—it might be possible to avoid such terminal consequences, but this is rare.

As an Asset: A sudden, vital resource can be elicited, when needed. Funds, a safe-house, something. When the situation is bleak and options are few, this can be a life-saving option.

Keywords: Desperate, Frightened, Paranoid

OLD FRIENDSHIP

A favor provided by an agent to someone, in the hope they might become an asset, leaves no trace. An unexpected sum of money is suspicious. It draws attention to itself, or it makes its owner act foolishly. A knife leaves marks, or, worse, a dead body which must be hidden or explained. These are clumsy methods. A true agent, an agent worthy of the trust placed in them, does not leave such obvious paths for a hunter to follow. Where is the harm in a favor, however? It's simply a friend trying to help a friend, after all. A perfectly normal, natural thing to want to do. Of course, gaining trust and building a relationship is not easy. It involves work, carefully assessing the intended target and determining what it is that they wish they could have, what it is that they need.

But once you have this knowledge, with care, you can maintain this friendship for years if necessary.

As an Asset: A companion you've known for some time, carefully compiling information on them and acting as their friend. They can provide you with information, spy on a target, or hide you when things become dangerous.

Keywords: Faithful, Reliable, Wily

SERVICE

Everything comes with a price. The universe depends on trade. Everything depends on commerce. But for those who are truly powerful, or those who understand how true power works and where it lies, currency is worthless. Favors... now, favors have value. Favors are the only currency, outside of spice, that holds its worth, that isn't susceptible to the fluctuations of market prices. You provide these services to large organizations and in return, you get to know where they send the resources you offer. They know they can call on you when things get tough. And you know you can call on them.

As an Asset: A large organization is in your pocket and, within reason, you can gain as much of a different asset as you require.

Keywords: Reliable, Valuable

INTRIGUE ASSETS: VALUABLES

Intrigue often centers around wealth and access to resources, and thus those things can be potent assets during any sort of social conflict. Business contracts and quantities of valuables are traded alongside information and favors and can be used as leverage just as easily... so long as you know what your opponent desires and you can fill that demand.

LAND RIGHTS

A step up from simply trading raw materials, access to the land where these materials are produced can be traded if the price is good enough, allowing whomever has access to generate as much of that raw material as they want... so long as they're willing to do the work. This can be something of a double-edged sword—everyone wants spice, but few are willing to face the dangers and difficulties of harvesting and refining it—but it can serve as part of a lucrative deal and create great opportunities for influence.

As an Asset: Leasing land rights to another can be lucrative, and place another party in a position where they're more open to other deals because they cannot afford to turn you down... but there's risk, because you're giving up some of your capacity to produce those same materials to another.

Keywords: Land, Production (plus other keywords according to the type of material, such as Scarce or Abundant)

MANUFACTURED GOODS

Your House manufactures something valuable, or you've managed to obtain some valuable goods which someone is likely to need. This might be technology or crafted items, such as shields, weapons, or vehicles, or it might be a refined substance ready for use, such as the various useful forms and substances that spice can be transformed into.

As an Asset: The ability to manufacture goods can expose you to the influence of whomever provides the raw materials, but finished goods are highly valuable cargo and access to them can open doors that might otherwise remain closed.

Keywords: Manufactured, Trade Goods (plus other keywords according to the goods, such as Scarce or Abundant)

RAW MATERIALS

You have access to a large quantity of the raw materials needed to produce other goods. This may vary from minerals and construction materials such as wood or metals, to raw foodstuffs such as particular kinds of meat or plant matter, and it may vary in rarity from commonplace (but needed in vast quantities) to extremely rare (but precious such as the spice melange). Access to quantities of materials can be useful for trade if you're dealing with someone who needs or wants those materials for something, but

anyone skilled in business will be looking for a better deal.

As an Asset: Trading raw materials is an easy way to get embroiled in an intrigue, and the ability to produce and distribute resources can be a powerful way to gain influence.

Keywords: Raw Materials, Trade Goods (plus other keywords according to the type of material, such as Scarce or Abundant)

SUPPLY CONTRACT

A one-off sale of goods is one thing, but a long-term contract can be a powerful tool in the halls where politics and trade align. A contract to produce goods for another faction can forge a lasting relationship with that faction and help turn their wealth to your advantage. In turn, contracting another faction to supply something to you can ensure you never lack for the resources you need. Either way, there's a lasting connection between both parties, which can allow for greater influence at a later date.

As an Asset: It's difficult to take hostile action against someone who supplies goods to you, or who you supply; these kinds of entanglements help preserve a semblance of peace in the Imperium, tying the interests of competing Houses together. A cunning player of this grand game can use that to their advantage.

Keywords: Long-term, Production, Trade (plus other keywords according to the goods, such as Scarce or Abundant)



VALUABLE ITEM

While not necessarily on the scale of trade contracts and land rights, individual valuable items can be potent assets in trade and intrigue. Items of artistic merit, unique creations of historical or religious value, and similar precious objects are highly sought-after, and their ownership often changes during times of political strife and turmoil, frequently serving as leverage for those possessed of great power, great ambition, and expensive tastes.

As an Asset: Valuable items are often relatively easy to move and trade, as they are frequently small and lightweight compared to their value. This makes them an excellent way of moving value from place to place discretely, which in turn makes them a useful tool during trade and negotiations.

Keywords: Fragile, Portable, Precious

INTRIGUE ASSETS: BLACKMAIL

It is a truism amongst agents that the louder a person denounces something, the more they secretly crave it—the clever blackmailer notices these tendencies, these not-so-hidden tells, and seeks to exploit them, laying temptation in the path of their intended victim, or offering the possibility of access to such forbidden fruits. Often this takes time; the agent has to gradually insinuate themselves, shrugging off the initial angry denials of interest or threats. But little by little, the resistance is overcome, and the desire wins out. And then, when the bait has been taken, the agent's trap is sprung. Demanding money in exchange for keeping harmful secrets, blackmail is a messy business and there are Houses within the Landsraad who pride themselves as being above such underhanded methods of attaining leverage. But for those agents and Houses unconcerned by the underhandedness of such techniques, there is much to be gained. There is little more powerful than the threat of exposure hanging over the head of an asset. Of course, as with any intrigue asset, time must be expended to select the most appropriate form of blackmail record—to find the thing that is sufficient to ensure obedience, as well as guaranteeing silence after the asset has fulfilled their function. Anything that cannot command both obedience and silence exposes not only the victim, but the agent as well.

HOSTAGE

For those prepared to truly commit their resources to such a thing, blackmail can go far. The kidnap of a loved one, a family member, or a close friend—and the threat of harm being committed against them—can be enough to break even the most devoted of servants to a House. Some Mentats even hypothesize that such an extreme approach might be sufficient to shatter the Imperial conditioning. Of course, no one has ever had chance to test such an outlandish theory, but it nevertheless persists. While shame, ridicule, exile, or death are powerful

motivators—of the kind that threaten those subject to exposure from more traditional modes of blackmail—the ongoing torture of a loved one might be sufficient to make a person do anything to achieve its cessation. Only the mind of a particularly twisted variety of Mentat is even capable of conjecturing such things, but nevertheless, such creatures do exist.

As an Asset: Kidnapped, imprisoned, and fearful, a hostage is an extremely potent form of leverage, but also carries commensurately high risks. Keeping the hostage well can be difficult, and preventing them from escaping can also require resources.

Keywords: Frightened, Trapped, Valuable

ILLICIT RECORDING

It is human nature to want things. It is human nature to want things that one isn't allowed to have. Drugs, flesh, money... whatever the laws of the Landsraad forbid, or the rules of a House prohibit, human nature desires more. And when have laws and other such trivialities ever prevented people from doing precisely what they wish? After all, there are always those willing to give into forbidden desires and those prepared to profit from it. Not simply through fulfilling the desire and taking payment, of course. Many are prepared to do just that, but some special individuals are prepared to go a little further... 'accidentally' recording such illicit activities in one form or another, before filing it away, ready and waiting for the moment when it becomes useful.

As an Asset: Recordings, visual or audible, of an asset's illegal (or at least extremely embarrassing) practices. Can be related to drugs, sex, or other activities an agent's target wants to remain hidden.

Keywords: Damaging, Embarrassing

STOLEN FILE

Politics requires its players to wear different masks at different times, depending on the circumstances they find themselves in. A staunch ally of the Atrides today may become the bosom companion of the Harkonnens tomorrow. It's the way of things and entirely accepted, so long as no one can ever prove those previous allegiances. As long as no one has, say, a record of payments made to an assassin to kill a Harkonnen aide. Or the footage of an asset stealing from the Atrides spice supply. Of course, getting hold of such proofs can be difficult, but worth it. Most definitely worth it.

As an Asset: Proof of a target's various machinations against a current employer; extracted from the personal files of the target, these are powerful inducements to ensure a target's continued good behavior.

Keywords: Damaging, Illicit, Subtle

INTRIGUE ASSETS: CONTACTS

Every agent needs them. Any agent who survives for more than a month likely has them. Contacts are an agent's eyes, ears, and, less frequently, mouthpiece. Agents can't be everywhere, and just as a Mentat has agents everywhere to provide information and analysis they can synthesize, so too does an agent have as many contacts as possible. These contacts are drawn from all the different echelons of society—from the dregs, clinging to life in the gutter outside a Harkonnen palace, to the spice dealer who travels in luxury aboard a CHOAM ship—and all require different things, just as they provide different information back to the agent. Each of these contacts must be handled with care, paid, cared for... nurtured.

BLACK MARKET TRADER

You need things, naturally. Some of those things are easy to obtain, purchasable in any bazaar, any market, any shop. Other things require sourcing more carefully. That's what black market contacts are for. Anything you need, they can usually find. Yes, they charge a lot, but you get what you pay for. And you might end up looking for some very obscure and illegal stuff. So, you're going to need someone trustworthy, or at least, trustworthy enough.

As an Asset: Someone with one foot in the mercantile world and the other in the underworld. They can get you what you need when you need it. No questions asked, so long as the money is right.

Keywords: Experienced, Resourceful, Well-known

COURTESAN

Sex is always a powerful lure, and a courtesan of any gender is a useful contact. People are rarely as guarded when undressed, and a skilled courtesan can learn much, both from conversation and from a quick study of what a person keeps in their pockets—and what company they keep. The courtesan is an ally and a contact of the highest usefulness, provided you can find one prepared to offer such information. The risk of being caught, and the punishment involved for a courtesan selling information, is much higher than that for any other role. The rewards must therefore be much greater.

As an Asset: A trained courtesan with access to the bedchambers of the wealthy and influential, capable of discovering a great deal if handled carefully.

Keywords: Attractive, Cunning, Resourceful

EX-AGENT

As long as the Landsraad has worked to undermine each other, as long as the Padishah Emperor has watched the affairs of the Houses with paranoid panic, there have been agents. They work to collect information, to spy on the comings and goings of the Houses, to influence the fate

of worlds. A few of these agents retire, some are driven out, and some escape. Some even survive outside of their House. But some never entirely escape the life, and remain at its periphery, calling upon their old training and network of contacts to remain viable and to turn their former experience into profit.

Ex-agents inevitably know other former or even active agents, and can call on them now and then, for advice, for direction, for the kind of favors old agents understand better than anyone else. However, due to the nature of the game, these are not the most trustworthy people, and should be utilized with caution.

As an Asset: This is a former agent encountered and trusted in the past, able to be called on for a safe place to hide or tips on the moves being made by opponents.

Keywords: Experienced, Intelligent, Wily

INTRIGUE ASSETS: COURTIERS

The Padishah Emperor is the most powerful person in the universe, and like any great ruler in any era of human culture, he has established a court around him. Here people of every gender, every creed, every culture gather to earn his regard and, for those fortunate few, benefit from it. Courtiers are found throughout the inhabited universe, sometimes occupying positions of power, sometimes awaiting an opportunity to seize such power for themselves. Courtiers are as varied in character as they are in origin. Some are genuine artists, hoping to earn patronage from the Emperor or from some Great House. Others are ruthless politicians, accruing influence and watching for the moment when it can be most effectively deployed. Naturally, this latter type is the most dangerous, but all the various kinds of courtier can be useful to an agent prepared to learn how they each work.

AMBITIOUS NEWCOMER

Gaining access to the court of the Padishah Emperor can be difficult, even for experienced and well-connected agents. Finding someone who understands the right hand signals, the right gestures to gain admittance to this sanctum, to that library, is a vital step for anyone hoping to situate themselves at the ultimate nexus of power. It is not simply about admission, either. Without the right guide to the myriad factions and shifting allegiances of the Imperial court, even the most sagacious agent can become entirely lost. Newcomers to court with the connections to make their way swiftly up the ranks are ideal targets for agents trying to infiltrate the court—potentially powerful, but inexperienced enough to be taken in by a quick enough tongue.

As an Asset: Recently arrived at the Emperor's court, this scion of a House or otherwise well-connected youngster wants to rise quickly in the eyes of the court.

Keywords: Ambitious, Eager, Pushy

CONFIDANT OF THE EMPEROR

Those fortunate few who have gained the Emperor's favor are always on the lookout for novelty, for something to amuse or surprise the Padishah Emperor, and for someone who might one day be a useful scapegoat. There is little loyalty in the Imperial court; the Padishah Emperor's whims are far too changeable for that and, as a result, friendships and allegiances tend to be brief, though plentiful. An enemy in the morning might be a bosom companion by the evening and an attempted assassin by the time the sun has set. The Emperor's favorites rarely last long and use any means necessary to retain their position. This can be used by the cunning to their advantage, but it can also spell disaster...

As an Asset: Having risen high in the Emperor's esteem, this asset can get you in places and give you information few others can. But this comes with risks; they might be imprisoned or executed for displeasing the Emperor without warning, drawing you into the purge.

Keywords: Cunning, Paranoid, Ruthless

HOUSE RETAINER

Any House, by its nature, has a wide variety of associated and loyal personnel who serve the House's members and its best interests. The nature, quality, and responsibilities of these individuals varies dramatically, but all are extensions of the House itself, and as such are considered as assets.

As an Asset: Chapter 3: **Creating Your House** covers the creation of a House and establishes guidelines for creating retainer assets, before and during play.

Keywords: Familiar, Loyal

INDEBTED LANDOWNER

Not all who bear titles are wealthy, and due to the whims of the market or through political connivance, it is entirely possible that a landowner may be relatively poor, either

inhabiting a shell of a former estate—hollowed out by the necessity of selling possessions to survive—or subsisting entirely on a wave of debt incurred to maintain the illusion of prosperity. At the end of the day when the accounting is complete, however, the House, and particularly its head, is in debt.

As an Asset: Indebted landowners are potentially the most extreme of courtier assets, as they may range from fiercely loyal and hoping to better their status within the House ruling over them, to embittered has-beens who blame those above them for their sorry state, and can be utilized against the House by its enemies.

Keywords: Fallen, Indebted, Loyal or Disloyal (pick one)

POLITICIAN

A politician is an essential guide to precisely who is in favor, who is about to be in favor and who is about to experience a precipitous fall. Such information is utterly invaluable, enabling agents to plot strategies to ingratiate themselves with one faction at the expense of another. It is in the back-and-forth of courtier politics that the grand fiefs are handed out to those the Emperor wishes to reward (or to punish), and only those politicians intimately tied to the moods of the court, and to the rise and fall of individuals in the Emperor's favor, can predict certain upcoming changes. When Count Fenring was sent to Arrakis to inspect the Harkonnen operation, the move was common knowledge amongst the various politicians at court long before it began to filter through to the Landsraad.

As an Asset: A long-serving member of the court, having seen it all and survived various coup attempts, this asset knows everything and everyone, and is wily enough to avoid the worst of the fallout.

Keywords: Cunning, Intelligent, Wily



